

Historic Dancing





About the Course

Students will learn dances that were popular in the historical period being studied and perform them to some music of that period.

This topic is included in the following course(s): PE: Grades 7-12

PE: Grades 7-12

Lessons specifically created for Grades 7-12. We do recommend you prioritize the Historical Dance lessons as these are less likely to be obtained elsewhere and also give depth and richness to student's understanding of the time period. We recommend you make sure to include some sort of physical activity as breaks throughout your school day. If you already have sports or similar activities as a regular part of your life rhythms, these lessons are optional.



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is suitable for interested students in Grades 5-6 if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-12	Historic Dancing 1 time/week 20 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
PE: Grades 7-12				
Playground Games	Free Play/ Circuits	Sports	Free Play/ Circuits	Historic Dancing



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Historic Dancing

How To Teach



Overview

Mason emphasized that being physically fit is just as important as being mentally and spiritually fit. She used a combination of Swedish Drill (calisthenic exercises done to music or military-style commands), playground games, sports, dance, free play, and afternoon walks to make sure students had time for vigorous exercise every single day.



Introduce

Teach students the new song, dance, or sport. Tutorials are often provided.



Practice

Play your new game, practice your new dance, sing your new rhyme, etc.!

Historic Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 1

Sir Roger de Coverley

PREP: Watch instructional video to familiarize yourself with dance. Print Sir Roger de Coverley Instructions PDF.

→ INTRO

Sir Roger de Coverley is an English Country Dance originally published in *The Dancing Master* in 1695. It was widely danced in the 1700s and remained popular through the 1800s. It is most famously found in Charles Dickens's *A Christmas Carol*, at Fezziwig's ball. It is a finishing dance that was commonly danced at the end of a ball, where all attendees partnered up to close out the evening. It promoted good humor among the company and caused them all to leave having great satisfaction with one another. After the dance crossed the ocean and came over to America, it morphed into different variations and also became what we now know as the Virginia Reel. You will recognize the structure and formations as they have similarities.

→ VIEW

Watch the example of Sir Roger de Coverley. *Please note that there are many versions of Sir Roger de Coverley. Our example video differs from our instructional video.*

∞ Video Link: Sir Roger de Coverley

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Using Instructional Video, form pairs, designate diagonals, and learn Part 1 (meet in middle, right hand turn, left hand turn) without music. Instructor will need to cue dancers and count in 6's.

It is often helpful for the students to remain with the same partner week to week while learning the piece. Once mastered, they can change partners.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

∞ PDF Link: Sir Roger de Coverley Instructions PDF

WEEK 2 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 2

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Review head couple, diagonal 1, and diagonal 2. Review part 1 with diagonals (meet in middle, right hand turn, left hand).

→ LEARN

Learn the rest of Part 1 (2 hand turn and dos-a-dos).

→ PRACTICE

The entire Part 1 together without music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 3 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 3

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Entire Part 1.

→ LEARN

Part 2 Weaving and Promenade/Cast off.

→ PRACTICE

Parts 1 and 2 together without music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

Historic Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 4

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Parts 1 and 2.

→ PRACTICE

Parts 1 and 2 together without music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 5 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 5

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Parts 1 and 2.

→ LISTEN

To Sir Roger de Coverley music. While listening, practice clapping together to a portion of the music and then counting together by 6's. Go back to the beginning and practice counting the 6-count introduction, so students learn the intro begins right away.

→ PRACTICE

Parts 1 and 2 together with music. Instructor must call dancers in and say, "Remember to honor your partner (press play) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, Go!" *It is helpful if instructor counts by 6's during dance, ensuring students go in for 6 and out for 6.*

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

∞ Music Link: Music Sir Roger de Coverley

Music Credit: Thank you to Bill Matthiesen from the musical group, Spare Parts, who generously shared the Sir Roger de Coverley music with the Alveary. Please do not distribute or use music beyond the Alveary without permission.

WEEK 6 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 6

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Parts 1 and 2.

→ PRACTICE

Parts 1 and 2 together with music. *Remember to implement instructor's cues and counting from previous lesson.*

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

∞ Music Link: Music Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 7 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 7

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Parts 1 and 2 without music.

→ PRACTICE

Parts 1 and 2 with music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

∞ Music Link: Music Sir Roger de Coverley

Historic Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 8 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 8

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ REVIEW

Parts 1 and 2 without music.

→ DANCE

Entire dance with music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Sir Roger de Coverley

∞ Music Link: Music Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 9 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 9

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ DANCE

Dance Sir Roger de Coverley from the beginning with music. If mastered, students may change partners.

∞ Music Link: Music Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 10 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 10

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ DANCE

Dance Sir Roger de Coverley from the beginning with music. If mastered, students may change partners.

∞ Music Link: Music Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 11 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 11

Sir Roger de Coverley

→ DANCE

Dance Sir Roger de Coverley from the beginning with music. If mastered, students may change partners.

∞ Music Link: Music Sir Roger de Coverley

WEEK 12 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Historic Dancing



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 13

Capoeira

→ PREP

Watch instructional video to familiarize yourself with warm up and dance.
Print or have a digital copy of Capoeira PDF while teaching Capoeira.

→ INTRO

Capoeira History: "Capoeira is a Brazilian art form that developed from combat games enslaved Africans brought to Brazil during the colonial period. It features dance, martial arts, music, songs, acrobatics, and, many would say, a particular philosophy. In performance practitioners form a circle ("roda") where eight of them play instruments creating a groove that supports songs and the physical action. Songs are in Portuguese and the instruments are all percussion, with the exception of the berimbau, three musical bows that lead the musical ensemble. Players take turns to come to the center of the circle in couples for the physical action. These physical encounters are known as jogos (games), neither a dance, nor a combat. During the performance, sometimes players seem to be dancing and other times to be fighting. This ambiguity is integral to capoeira and practitioners strive to balance the two. With a legacy linked to resistance and liberation from Portuguese colonizers and enslavers, many practitioners nowadays see capoeira as a symbol of cultural resistance and an instrument to educate and raise awareness about racial inequality. These views have been multiplied since the 1980s when capoeira became globalized." - Mestre Cobra Mansa (recognized Capoeira Angola master based in Brazil)

→ VIEW

Example of Capoeira.

∞ Video Link: Capoeira 1

∞ Video Link: Capoeira 2

→ LEARN

Warm Up and Ginga.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

∞ PDF Link: Capoeira PDF

WEEK 2 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 14

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review Ginga.

∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ LEARN

Role and Au.

→ PRACTICE

Practice Role and Au with instructional video.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

WEEK 3 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 15

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review Ginga, Role, and Au.

∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ LEARN

Learn Esquiva Lateral and Esquiva Baixa.



Term 2

→ PRACTICE

Esquiva Lateral and Esquiva Baixa with instructional video.
∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

WEEK 4 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 16

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review Ginga, Role, Au, Esquiva Lateral, and Esquiva Baixa.
∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ LEARN

Learn Meia Lua de Compassa and Armada.

→ PRACTICE

Meia Lua de Compassa and Armada with instructional video.
∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

WEEK 5 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 17

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review Ginga, Role, Au, Esquiva Lateral, Esquiva Baixa, Meia Lua de Compassa, and Armada.
∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ LEARN

Learn Double Kick and Queixada.

→ PRACTICE

Double Kick and Queixada with instructional video.
∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

WEEK 6 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 18

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review Ginga, Role, Au, Esquiva Lateral, Esquiva Baixa, Meia Lua de Compassa, Armada, Double Kick, and Queixada.
∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

Capoeira is performed as an improvisational, non-choreographed duel between two people in a “roda” (circle) where they escape movement without touch or resistance. At the cue of the lead instrument (the berimbau), the two players begin by shaking hands or sharing a hug to show respect and affirm the “fight” is a friendly game. Movements are spontaneous without a fixed pattern, and a movement dialogue is created. Though Capoeira is not performed like a set, memorized dance, for educational purposes, we have put together the steps we have learned into a dance. As you become familiar with some of the steps, you may pair up with classmates and slowly and carefully practice these moves spontaneously in pairs at your own timing. Remember, you are not trying to hurt your partner but create a dialogue of movement where one seeks to outmaneuver the other. Movements should be executed with care and control. If you want to explore Capoeira further, seek out in-person lessons in your area.

→ LEARN

Entire Capoeira dance using the instructional video without music.

Historic Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ PRACTICE

Entire dance.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

WEEK 7 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 19

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review individual steps: Ginga, Role, Au, Esquiva Lateral, Esquiva Baixa, Meia Lua de Compassa, Armada, Double Kick, and Queixada.

∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ REVIEW

Entire dance from the beginning without music.

→ PRACTICE

Entire Capoeira dance using the instructional video without music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

WEEK 8 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 20

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review Ginga, Role, Au, Esquiva Lateral, Esquiva Baixa, Meia Lua de Compassa, Armada, Double Kick, and Queixada.

∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ REVIEW

Entire dance from the beginning without music.

→ PRACTICE

Entire dance from the beginning with music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

∞ Music Link: Capoeira Music

WEEK 9 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 21

Capoeira

→ WARM UP & REVIEW

Complete Warm Up and review Ginga, Role, Au, Esquiva Lateral, Esquiva Baixa, Meia Lua de Compassa, Armada, Double Kick, and Queixada.

∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ REVIEW

Entire dance from the beginning without music.

→ PRACTICE

Entire dance from the beginning with music.

∞ Video Link: Instructional Capoeira

∞ Music Link: Capoeira Music

WEEK 10 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 22

Capoeira

→ WARM UP

Complete Warm Up.

∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03)

→ DANCE

Dance the Capoeira dance from the beginning with music.

∞ Music Link: Capoeira Music



Term 2

WEEK 11 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 23 Capoeira → WARM UP Complete Warm Up. ∞ Music Link: Warm Up Music (begin at 08:34 - 17:03) → DANCE Dance the Capoeira dance from the beginning with music. ∞ Music Link: Capoeira Music	
WEEK 12 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Historic Dancing	



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 25

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ PREP

Watch instructional video to familiarize yourself with dance. Print or have a digital copy of The Lancers Quadrille PDF while teaching dance.

→ INTRO

The Lancer's Quadrille is a set of 5 dances: La Dorset, La Lodoiska, La Native, Les Graces, and Les Lanciers, originally published in 1817 by John Duval. The quadrille was first derived from French military parades, where four mounted horsemen would make square formations. Further influence came from French Country Dances or Cotillion dances popular at the time. (Remember, we learned a Cotillion dance last year, George Washington's Favourite!) The quadrille first appeared as the *quadrille de contredanse* in late 18th-century France but really became popular once reaching English ballrooms and International high society in 1815. The quadrille is made up of 8 dancers, 4 couples facing into the center of the square. When you heard "square," did anyone think of square dancing? If so, you were correct! The quadrille is one of the primary historical predecessors of the American square dance. Today, we will begin learning Les Lanciers, the final movement of the Lancer's Quadrille.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille 1
Begin at Time Marker 12:14.

∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille 2

→ LEARN

Learn Individual steps.
∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video
∞ PDF Link: The Lancers Quadrille PDF

WEEK 2 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 26

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ REVIEW

Individual steps.

→ LEARN

Intro and Grand Chain.

→ PRACTICE

Practice Intro and Grand Chain without music.
∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video

WEEK 3 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 27

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ REVIEW

Individual steps, Intro, and Grand Chain.

→ LEARN

Couple's Column and Chassez Crossing (Featuring Couple 1).

→ PRACTICE

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, and Chassez Crossing without music.
∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video



Term 3

WEEK 4 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 28

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ REVIEW

Individual steps, Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, and Chassez Crossing without music.

→ LEARN

Casting Off to Column.

→ PRACTICE

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, Chassez Crossing, Casting Off to Column without music.

∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video

WEEK 5 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 29

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ REVIEW

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, Chassez Crossing, Casting Off to Column without music.

→ LEARN

Advance Forward/Back.

→ PRACTICE

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, Chassez Crossing, Casting Off to Column, Advance Forward/Back without music.

∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video

WEEK 6 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 30

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ REVIEW

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, Chassez Crossing, Casting Off to Column, Advance Forward/Back without music.

→ LEARN

Repeat of the dance featuring Couples 2, 3, and 4.

→ PRACTICE

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, Chassez Crossing, Casting Off to Column, Advance Forward/Back, and incorporate Couples 2, 3, and 4 without music.

∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video

WEEK 7 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 31

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ REVIEW

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, Chassez Crossing, Casting Off to Column, Advance Forward/Back, and Couples 2, 3, and 4 without music.

→ LEARN

Grand Square.

→ PRACTICE

Intro, Grand Chain, Couple's Column, Chassez Crossing, Casting Off to Column, Advance Forward/Back, Couples 2, 3, and 4, and Grand Square without music.

∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video

Historic Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 8 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 32

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ PRACTICE

Practice the dance without music a couple of times. Practice the dance with music.

∞ Video Link: The Lancers Quadrille Instructional Video

∞ Music Link: Les Lanciers

Music Credit: Thank you to the musical group, Green Ginger, who generously shared Les Lanciers music with the Alveary. Please do not distribute or use music beyond the Alveary without permission. greenginger.bandcamp.com

WEEK 9 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 33

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ DANCE

Dance The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers).

∞ Music Link: Les Lanciers

WEEK 10 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 34

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ DANCE

Dance The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers).

∞ Music Link: Les Lanciers

WEEK 11 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 35

The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers)

→ DANCE

Dance The Lancers Quadrille (5th set, Les Lanciers).

∞ Music Link: Les Lanciers

WEEK 12 20m Historic Dancing - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Historic Dancing

Historic Dancing

Examination

Term 1 · Dance Sir Roger de Coverley.

Term 2 · Dance Capoeira.

Term 3 · Dance The Lancers Quadrille.